MATH INQUIRERS PLACEMENT CHECK

Ages 9-11

Typically children finishing Primary 4, and open to a year either side • About 30 minutes • No calculator

Name: _____ Date: _____

How it works. Your child answers on their own. Read a question aloud if they ask, but do not help with the maths. If they are stuck, say "Try your best, or skip it", and move on. Write the answer in the box. Working on scrap paper is fine.

Warm-up

1 5000 - 1346 = ?

2 A bag has 9 sweets. How many sweets are in 7 bags?

3 Fill in the blank: 2/3 = ?/12

4 A rectangle is 7 cm long and 6 cm wide. What is its area? Write your answer with units.

Main questions

5 Write down all the factors of 18.

6 Round 48,572 to the nearest thousand.

7 12 + 6 x 3 - 4 = ?

8 2 and 3/5 + 1 and 4/5 = ? Write your answer as a mixed number.

9 A ribbon is 3.7 m long. Another ribbon is 2.85 m long. What is the total length? Write your answer in metres.

10 A rectangle has a perimeter of 36 cm. It is 11 cm long. How wide is it?

Brain stretchers

11 I am a number between 30 and 50. I am a multiple of 4 and a multiple of 6. My digits add up to 9. What number am I?

12 Ben has 3 times as many marbles as Cara. Ben gives 12 marbles to Cara. Now they have the same number. How many marbles did Ben have at first?

FOR THE TUTOR OR PARENT

Answer key and scoring

Accept equivalent forms (for example $2.05 and 2.05). One mark per question.

Warm-up (4 marks)

#	Question	Answer	Watch for
1	5000 - 1346 = ?	**3654**	Watch for borrowing across zeros; common error 4346 or 3764.
2	A bag has 9 sweets. How many sweets are in 7 bags?	**63**	Check recall of 9 x 7; note if the child skip-counts slowly.
3	Fill in the blank: 2/3 = ?/12	**8**	Does the child multiply top and bottom by 4? Common error: 2 + 9 = 11.
4	A rectangle is 7 cm long and 6 cm wide. What is its area? Write your answer with units.	**42 square cm**	Common error: giving perimeter 26 cm or omitting 'square'.

Main questions (6 marks)

#	Question	Answer	Watch for
5	Write down all the factors of 18.	**1, 2, 3, 6, 9, 18**	Look for pairs (1 x 18, 2 x 9, 3 x 6). Common errors: missing 1 or 18, or listing multiples (18, 36...).
6	Round 48,572 to the nearest thousand.	**49,000**	Check which digit they look at (the hundreds digit, 5). Common error: 48,000 or 48,600.
7	12 + 6 x 3 - 4 = ?	**26**	Multiplication first: 6 x 3 = 18, then 12 + 18 - 4. Common error: 50 (left to right).
8	2 and 3/5 + 1 and 4/5 = ? Write your answer as a mixed number.	**4 and 2/5**	Look for 3/5 + 4/5 = 7/5 = 1 and 2/5, then add whole numbers. Also accept 22/5. Common error: 3 and 7/5 left unconverted, or 4 and 7/10.
9	A ribbon is 3.7 m long. Another ribbon is 2.85 m long. What is the total length? Write your answer in metres.	**6.55 m**	Check place-value alignment of decimal points. Common error: 6.12 or 5.82 (misaligned).
10	A rectangle has a perimeter of 36 cm. It is 11 cm long. How wide is it?	**7 cm**	Look for 36 / 2 = 18, then 18 - 11 = 7. Common errors: 25 (36 - 11) or 14.

Brain stretchers (2 marks)

#	Question	Answer	Watch for
11	I am a number between 30 and 50. I am a multiple of 4 and a multiple of 6. My digits add up to 9. What number am I?	**36**	Look for listing multiples of 4 and 6 (common: 36, 48) then using the digit clue. Accept guess and check with reasoning.
12	Ben has 3 times as many marbles as Cara. Ben gives 12 marbles to Cara. Now they have the same number. How many marbles did Ben have at first?	**36**	Bar model: after the gift, Ben's 3 units minus 12 equals Cara's 1 unit plus 12, so 2 units = 24, 1 unit = 12. Cara 12, Ben 36.

YOUR CHILD'S RESULT

Which level fits?

Add up the marks, then find your row. This is a guide. You make the final choice, and you can change level free of charge before lesson 1.

Warm-up marks: _____ / 4 **Main + stretch marks:** _____ / 8

Main + stretch	What it suggests
6 to 8	Join **Ages 9-11 (P4)**. Your child has the foundations and will be well challenged. If they scored 8 of 8 and all 4 warm-up marks, you can also try the Ages 10-12 (P5) check.
4 or 5	Join **Ages 9-11 (P4)**, and expect some support. If the warm-up score is 2 or less, Ages 8-10 (P3) may be the more comfortable start.
0 to 3	We suggest **Ages 8-10 (P3)**. The ideas build step by step, and a confident start matters more than a fast one.

Strong?
Choose the level that fits the score, not the school year. A child who finds this easy will enjoy the challenge questions in class.

Not yet?
That is useful to know, not a failure. Starting one level down means more success and more joy in class.

Skills covered

Subtraction and times tables; Factors and multiples; Rounding 5-digit numbers; Order of operations; Fractions (mixed numbers); Decimals; Area and perimeter; Bar models and number puzzles

Next step. Send the score and your preferred level to us when you enrol. Prices are the same at every level, and your tutor can talk it through first. Small groups of up to 8, live online.